

Retail Flow

Quantifies retail money flow, positioning, and activity and systematically takes contrarian positions.

Retail Flow measures and responds to retail investor activity. By analyzing individual executed trades sourced from exchanges, it identifies assets heavily influenced by retail participation and takes systematically contrarian positions, seeking to exploit predictable patterns of overreaction and herding. Order sizes and types differentiate retail from institutional activity; five distinct techniques quantify trade imbalances and are combined in an ensemble without optimization or parameter fitting.

The universe consists of the most liquid and actively traded assets, identified on a rolling basis and survivorship-bias free. Positions are scaled by the inverse of rolling volatility; the factor is available point-in-time with hourly updates.

EXAMPLE TOP 40 CROSS-SECTIONAL PORTFOLIO

Long and short the dynamic, rolling Top 40 universe (point-in-time), sized by the factor's cross-sectional strength. Rebalanced daily.

[Download Returns \(CSV\)](#) →

PERFORMANCE

Report Period Start Date Nov 2020 • End Date Aug 2026

Cumulative Returns

MTD	Last Month	1M	3M	YTD
0.6%	-2.0%	0.6%	-0.5%	5.9%

Annualised Returns (CAGR)

1Y	3Y	5Y	SI
-1.8%	9.2%	8.8%	15.4%

RISK PROFILE

Realised Volatility (annualised)

1M	3M	1Y	3Y	5Y	SI
8.8%	9.2%	11.0%	12.3%	12.3%	15.5%

Max Drawdown

%	Date
-17.2%	2021-02-28

CUMULATIVE RETURN



Note – Performance is for an illustrative single-factor portfolio (positions sized proportionally to the factor signal across the Top 40 universe, rebalanced daily); demonstrative only, not a tradable product. Past performance is not indicative of future results.

Factor Analysis

[Download Factor Data \(CSV\)](#) →

Diagnostics on the raw factor values, independent of portfolio construction: the quantile and IC plots show whether the signal cross-sectionally separates out- from under-performers, and how consistently. Computed point-in-time on the rolling Top 40 universe (the live factor spans many more tokens – see the raw factor-data CSV in the data room).

Quantile means unavailable: loop of ufunc does not support argument 0 of type int which has no callable sqrt method

Cumulative quantile unavailable: loop of ufunc does not support argument 0 of type int which has no callable sqrt method

IC unavailable: 'float' object has no attribute 'shape'

ABOUT APERIODIC FACTORS

Aperiodic Factors publishes a catalog of cross-sectional, market-neutral crypto factors – each with point-in-time history and live signals – built for systematic research and backtesting. Full catalog, methodology and API at factors.aperiodic.io; see the materials below.

[View this factor on factors.aperiodic.io](#) →

[Replication notebook – full AlphaLens analysis](#) →

Have further questions? Book a call with our team – factors.aperiodic.io/booking

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